

ADA / WCAG 2.1 Accessibility Audit

Colorado Judicial Branch — Docket Search Page

Page	Colorado Judicial Branch — Docket Search
URL	https://www.coloradojudicial.gov/dockets
Standard	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.1, Level AA
Audit Date	May 5, 2026
Method	Code- and structure-level review of public HTML; not a substitute for automated scanning, screen-reader testing, or live keyboard testing.

Summary

The Docket Search page demonstrates a strong accessibility foundation. Page structure, landmark use, form labeling, heading hierarchy, alternative text, and language attribution all meet or exceed common conformance expectations. Ten issues are identified, four of which are higher priority and should be addressed first: a skip-link target that does not point to a real landmark, an orphaned form label that remains visible when its input is hidden, two navigation regions sharing the same accessible name, and a duplicate element id on the page. The remaining six items are medium and low priority and can be addressed during routine maintenance.

What the Page Does Well

Page structure and landmarks. A single <main>, one <header> (banner), one <footer> (contentinfo), and six <nav> elements — all with accessible labels via aria-labelledby.
Skip navigation link. “Skip to main content” is present and functional.
Page language. Correctly set with lang="en" on <html>.
Page title. Descriptive: “Docket Search Colorado Judicial Branch.”
Image alt text. All images have alternative text — the logo is alt="Home" and the hero image is alt="Dockets".
Form structure. All <select>, <input>, and <textarea> fields are properly associated with <label> elements via for / id. All radio groups use <fieldset> and <legend>.
Heading hierarchy. Logical (H1 → H2).
Live region. An aria-live="polite" region is present for dynamic updates.

Breadcrumb navigation. Properly labeled via `aria-labelledby="system-breadcrumb"`.

Issues Found

High Priority

1. Skip-link Target is an `<a>` Element, Not a Landmark

WCAG 2.4.1 (Bypass Blocks, Level A) · Fail

The skip link points to `#main-content`, but that id is attached to an empty `<a>` tag with `tabindex="-1"`, not the `<main>` landmark itself. Screen readers expect the target to be the `<main>` element (or another landmark). If the `<a>` has no text and no focusable content, keyboard users may skip to a void location.

Fix. Move `id="main-content"` to the `<main>` element, or ensure the anchor target receives focus correctly.

2. “Specify A Date” Field is Hidden but Its Label Remains Visible

WCAG 1.3.1 (Info and Relationships, Level A) · Fail

When “Specific Date” is not selected in the Date Range dropdown, the `input[type="date"]` is hidden (`display: none`) but the `<label>` element for “Specify A Date” remains in the DOM with `display: block`. This can confuse assistive technologies and create orphaned labels.

Fix. Hide both the input and its associated label together, or use `aria-hidden` on the label when the field is not active.

3. Duplicate `<nav>` Landmark Label — “Secondary navigation” Appears Twice

WCAG 2.4.6 (Headings and Labels, Level AA) · Fail

Two separate `<nav>` elements are both labeled “Secondary navigation” (one in the desktop header, one in the mobile nav). Screen-reader users who navigate by landmarks will encounter two identically named navigation regions, which is ambiguous.

Fix. Distinguish the labels — for example, “Secondary navigation” and “Secondary navigation (mobile)” — or suppress the duplicate with `aria-hidden="true"` when it is visually hidden.

4. Duplicate Page Element ID

WCAG 4.1.1 (Parsing, Level A) · Fail

`id="views-exposed-form-general-content-search-api-block-general-content-search-api-mini"` appears on two separate elements. Duplicate ids break `aria-labelledby` and for associations and are invalid HTML.

Fix. Ensure all ids on the page are unique. The duplicate is likely the mobile and desktop search form being rendered twice.

Medium Priority

5. External-Link Indicator Text is Read Aloud by Screen Readers

WCAG 2.4.6 (Headings and Labels, Level AA) · Fail

Links such as “Online Payments,” “Livestreaming,” and “Workplace Culture Initiative” include a `<span>` with the text “(Link is external)” that is not `aria-hidden="true"`. Screen readers will read the full text — for example, “Online Payments open paren Link is external close paren.” This is verbose and potentially confusing.

Fix. Add `aria-hidden="true"` to the “(Link is external)” indicator spans. If the external indication should be conveyed to assistive technology, add `aria-label` or a visually hidden phrase such as “, opens in a new tab” to the link itself.

6. “Docket Search Form” H2 is Visually Hidden

WCAG 1.3.1 (Info and Relationships, Level A) · Minor

The `<h2>Docket Search Form</h2>` is clipped with `clip: rect(1px, 1px, 1px, 1px)` and absolutely positioned off-screen. While this is a valid screen-reader-only technique, sighted users have no visible heading demarcating the form section and rely only on the bold “Location” and “Date” section titles inside fieldsets.

Fix. Consider making this heading visible, or at minimum ensure the visually hidden technique uses a proper `.sr-only` pattern consistently. This is a minor usability concern rather than a clear failure.

7. autocomplete Attributes Missing on Name and Search Fields

WCAG 1.3.5 (Identify Input Purpose, Level AA) · Fail

The following text inputs lack `autocomplete` attributes, which help users (especially those with cognitive disabilities or motor impairments) avoid re-typing information: First Name, Last Name, Business Name, Attorney First Name, Attorney Last Name, Division, Case Sequence, and 4-Digit Year.

Fix. Add appropriate `autocomplete` values — e.g. `autocomplete="given-name"`, `autocomplete="family-name"`, `autocomplete="organization"` — per the HTML specification.

8. Breadcrumb Does Not Mark the Current Page

WCAG 2.4.8 (Location, Level AAA / best practice at AA) · Best Practice

The breadcrumb shows “Home > Docket Search,” but the current page item (“Docket Search”) lacks `aria-current="page"`. Screen readers use this attribute to announce the current location.

Fix. Add `aria-current="page"` to the final breadcrumb `<li>` or its inner link or span.

Low Priority / Best Practice

9. Mobile Navigation Toggle Uses a CSS Checkbox Hack

WCAG 4.1.2 (Name, Role, Value, Level A) · Fail

The hamburger menu is implemented as a visually hidden `<input type="checkbox">` with a `<label>` (a common Drupal pattern). While it has a label (“Toggle Navigation”), it lacks `aria-expanded` and `aria-controls` attributes that screen readers use to understand collapsible-navigation state.

Fix. Add `aria-expanded="true|false"` and `aria-controls` pointing to the navigation menu id on the toggle element. Consider replacing the checkbox pattern with a `<button>` element for cleaner semantics.

10. Case Class Options Use Abbreviations Without Full Descriptions

WCAG 3.3.2 (Labels or Instructions, Level A) · Fail

Options such as C, CR, CV, CW, DR, JD, and JV are not self-explanatory. Users with cognitive disabilities or those unfamiliar with court case codes may not understand what these mean.

Fix. Expand option labels — e.g. “CR — Criminal” — or provide a visible legend or help text explaining the abbreviations.

Priority Summary

Issues are listed in the order they are described above. Severity reflects likely barrier to a screen-reader or keyboard-only user completing a docket search task.

#	Issue	WCAG Criterion	Severity
1	Skip-link points to empty <a>, not <main>	2.4.1 (A)	High
2	Hidden date field's label remains visible	1.3.1 (A)	High
3	Duplicate "Secondary navigation" landmark label	2.4.6 (AA)	High
4	Duplicate element ID on page	4.1.1 (A)	High
5	"(Link is external)" text read aloud by screen readers	2.4.6 (AA)	Medium
6	"Docket Search Form" H2 visually hidden	1.3.1 (A)	Medium
7	Missing autocomplete on name and search fields	1.3.5 (AA)	Medium
8	No aria-current="page" on breadcrumb	2.4.8 (AAA)	Low
9	Mobile nav toggle lacks aria-expanded / aria-controls	4.1.2 (A)	Low
10	Case Class options use unexplained abbreviations	3.3.2 (A)	Low

Recommended Remediation Order

1. Fix the skip-link target (Issue 1) and the duplicate element id (Issue 4). Both are foundational issues that affect every visitor regardless of which form fields they ultimately interact with.
2. Resolve the orphaned date label (Issue 2) and the duplicate "Secondary navigation" landmark name (Issue 3). These directly affect screen-reader navigation and form comprehension.
3. Address the medium-priority items (Issues 5, 6, and 7) during the next regular content or template release. Issue 7 in particular benefits a wide range of users beyond those typically considered when adding autocomplete support.
4. Handle the low-priority items (Issues 8, 9, and 10) as part of routine maintenance or the next platform upgrade. Replacing the checkbox-based mobile toggle with a <button> element (Issue 9) is a particularly clean win when the navigation template is next touched.

Scope and Limitations

This audit is based on a structural review of the page's public HTML and is not a substitute for a full accessibility evaluation. A complete audit would additionally include automated testing (axe-core, WAVE, Lighthouse), manual screen-reader testing across NVDA, JAWS, and VoiceOver, keyboard-only navigation testing, color-contrast measurement on the rendered DOM at the exact rendered pixel sizes, and testing of the page after performing a search (results-state accessibility was not evaluated). This document does not constitute legal advice regarding compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act, Colorado House Bill

21-1110, Section 508 of the Rehabilitation Act, or any other statute or regulation. It is a technical conformance review against WCAG 2.1 Level AA criteria intended to support a remediation conversation with the operator of the page.